



## IMPOSTER SYNDROME | EXERCISE 1

### Implementing Best Practice

To effectively combat imposter syndrome, it's important to incorporate best practice into your daily/weekly/monthly routine. Here are some ways to do this using the template provided:

1

#### Daily Routine:

Whenever you have a negative thought about your abilities write it down. Spend 10 minutes at the end of each day reviewing this and reframing those thoughts. Respond to them as if you were advising a friend. This can provide a new perspective.

##### ORIGINAL THOUGHT

I have never done this before and I will fail.



##### REFRAMED THOUGHT

I've taken on similar tasks and been successful.

My manager criticised my work, I'm no good at my job.



My manager's criticism may be valid, I'll try to learn from it and apply their suggestions in future.

I made a mistake at work.



Mistakes happen, no-one is infallible, I'll work through this.

2

#### Weekly Check-ins:



At the end of each week update your Success Bank (Exercise 1 'Self-efficacy').



Update your separate Skills Inventory to reflect formal learning you have undertaken.



Review your strengths and weaknesses. Identify areas for improvement and acknowledge areas where you excel.

3

#### Monthly Review:



Schedule feedback sessions with your manager or mentor, either monthly or on completion of a significant piece of work (e.g. project/presentation).



Collectively review your strengths and weaknesses and discuss the best way to enhance your capabilities either through formal or on-the-job training.



## IMPOSTER SYNDROME | EXERCISE 1

# Implementing Best Practice - Exercise Template

**DAILY TASK** – Record negative thoughts, spend 10 mins reviewing & reframing them at end of day

| DATE     | NEGATIVE THOUGHT                                              | REFRAMED THOUGHT                                        |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| dd/mm/yy | <i>Example - I've never done this before and I will fail.</i> | <i>I've taken on similar tasks and been successful.</i> |
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**WEEKLY TASKS** – Update Success Bank, Skills Inventory, and Strengths & Weaknesses

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**WEEKLY TASKS** – Update Success Bank, Skills Inventory, and Strengths & Weaknesses

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**WEEKLY TASKS** – Update Success Bank, Skills Inventory, and Strengths & Weaknesses

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**MONTHLY REVIEW** – Schedule feedback sessions with your manager/mentor, either monthly or on completion of a significant piece of work. Collectively review strengths/weaknesses, identify training needs.



## IMPOSTER SYNDROME | BEST PRACTICE

# Overcoming Imposter Syndrome in the Workplace

- **Use Cognitive Restructuring:** replace negative thoughts with fact, e.g. "I'm not qualified for this job" becomes "I was hired because I have the necessary skills and experience".
- **Keep a journal/Success Bank** to reflect upon accomplishments, certificates/awards, skills, experiences, successes, milestones and positive feedback, including external validation, e.g. recognitions and endorsements.
- **Self-Assessment:** periodically review your strengths and weaknesses. Identify areas for improvement and acknowledge areas where you excel.
- **Professional Development:** enhance your skills, capabilities and knowledge with workshops, courses, seminars. Keep a skills inventory and update regularly.
- **Define success:** to avoid unnecessary/unsustainable perfectionism, define what success means in each role or task and set clear achievable goals based on the context.
- **Celebrate your Successes:** acknowledge compliments positively, don't brush off successes, take time to reflect on a job well done.
- **Cultivate a growth mindset:** setbacks and challenges are integral to growth and learning.
- **Goal setting & Visualisation:** set realistic goals, break into achievable tasks, acknowledge when completed. Visualise yourself succeeding in specific scenarios to boost confidence and reduce fear.

## Seek Feedback and Mentorship:

- **Constructive Feedback/360° feedback:** Regularly seek feedback to gain perspective on your performance, support personal/professional development and improve self-awareness.
- **Mentorship:** Find a mentor, coach or supportive colleagues, who can offer guidance, share experiences and provide reassurance.
- **Peer Support:** connect with others experiencing imposter syndrome to normalise feelings.
- **Find confidantes** outside your professional sphere to avoid comparison if it helps.